M&A SAFARIS

Web & Mobile Application
Project Overview and Role-Based Features

Me and Adventure Safaris

Purpose

A simple functional document describing the proposed system, its main modules, user roles, permissions, website features, mobile application features, and key operating flows for client review and discussion.

Prepared for project discussion - August 2026

1. Project Overview

M&A Safaris is proposed as a complete digital platform for Me and Adventure Safaris. The platform will support the full customer journey from discovering Tanzania travel experiences to booking, payment, itinerary management, trip operations, and post-trip follow-up.

The solution should not be treated as only a tourism website. It is better classified as a:

Recommended System Classification

Safari Booking & Tour Operations Management Platform

The platform combines customer-facing sales and booking features with internal tools required to organize and deliver safari trips.

Platform Area	Primary Purpose
Public Website	Marketing, destinations, safari packages, inquiries, custom safari requests, and online booking.
Customer Mobile App / Portal	Manage bookings, payments, travelers, itinerary, trip updates, documents, support, and profile.
Operations Web Dashboard	Manage customers, bookings, custom itineraries, schedules, vehicles, drivers/guides, and trip preparation.
Admin Dashboard	Control the entire platform, staff access, packages, payments, reports, website content, and system settings.
Driver / Guide App or Staff Portal	View assigned trips, pickup details, itinerary, customer information required for the trip, and update trip progress.

2. Main Business Services Supported

Based on the current M&A Safaris company profile, the system should be flexible enough to support multiple travel products and services, including:

- Wildlife safaris and game drives
- Private and group safari packages
- Honeymoon and romantic getaways
- Family and luxury safaris
- Cultural and community experiences
- Mount Kilimanjaro adventures
- Day trips and excursions
- Airport transfers
- Car rental and chauffeur services
- Customized and tailor-made itineraries
- Corporate and group travel
- Beach and Zanzibar holidays

The platform should also allow the company to publish and manage destinations such as Arusha, Tarangire, Lake Manyara, Ngorongoro, Serengeti, Mount Kilimanjaro, Zanzibar, Mikumi, Udzungwa Mountains, and future destinations.

3. Recommended User Roles

For the first version, four core roles are recommended. Additional roles can be introduced later through permissions without redesigning the entire platform.

Role	Primary Responsibility
Admin	Full business and system control.
Operations / Booking Staff	Manage inquiries, customers, bookings, quotations, itineraries, trip preparation, and assignments.

Role	Primary Responsibility
Driver / Tour Guide	Manage only assigned trips and provide operational trip updates.
Customer / Tourist	Discover experiences, request or book trips, pay, manage travelers, and follow their itinerary.

Important Role Design Rule

A traveler or passenger does not need to be a separate system role. One Customer account may make a booking for several travelers. The additional travelers are stored under the booking and do not necessarily need user accounts.

4. Role 1 - Admin

The Admin is the highest operational role. The Admin manages the company platform, staff access, commercial content, bookings, operations, payments, and reporting.

Admin - Core Features

Dashboard

- View total bookings, pending bookings, confirmed bookings and cancellations.
- View revenue summaries and payment status.
- View upcoming, active and completed trips.
- View customer, staff and vehicle summaries.

Customer Management

- View all customer profiles and booking history.
- View inquiries and customer notes.
- Update customer information where authorized.
- Activate, suspend or deactivate customer accounts.

Booking Management

- Create bookings manually.
- View and edit all bookings.
- Confirm, reschedule, cancel or update booking status.
- Approve custom safari requests and quotations.
- Assign operations staff, driver/guide and vehicle.

Safari Packages & Destinations

- Create, edit, publish, unpublish or archive safari packages.
- Set pricing, duration, inclusions, exclusions and itinerary.
- Manage destination pages, activities, images and descriptions.

Custom Safari Management

- Review custom trip requests.
- Prepare itinerary and quotation.
- Set pricing and send offers to customers.
- Approve final custom trip arrangements.

Fleet & Staff

- Add and manage vehicles.
- Set vehicle availability or maintenance status.
- Create and manage staff accounts.
- Assign drivers and guides to trips.
- Manage role permissions.

Payments & Reports

- View transactions and balances.
- Confirm approved manual/offline payments where applicable.

- Initiate or review refunds according to company policy.
- View booking, revenue, customer, package, destination, staff and vehicle reports.

Content & Settings

- Manage website pages, services, gallery, testimonials and contact information.
- Manage company policies, currencies, taxes, notifications and booking settings.
- Manage integrations such as payment, email or SMS services.

Admin - Restrictions and Security Controls

- Admin should never be able to view customer passwords.
- Full payment card credentials must never be stored or displayed in the platform.
- Completed financial records should not be silently edited or deleted.
- Sensitive changes should create audit logs showing who changed what and when.
- Audit logs should not be deletable through normal Admin operations.

5. Role 2 - Operations / Booking Staff

Operations / Booking Staff manage the daily customer and trip preparation workflow. This role may represent a booking officer, tour consultant, reservations officer, or operations staff member depending on the company structure.

Operations / Booking Staff - Core Features

Daily Dashboard

- View new inquiries and custom safari requests.
- View pending quotations and payments.
- View upcoming arrivals, departures and active trips.
- View tasks requiring operational action.

Customer & Inquiry Management

- View relevant customer profiles and booking history.
- Create customer records when booking by phone, WhatsApp or office.
- Add internal customer notes and special requests.
- Communicate with customers through supported channels.

Booking Management

- Create and update bookings.
- Prepare and send quotations.
- Confirm bookings after required conditions are met.
- Reschedule trips and process cancellation requests according to policy.
- Update booking status.

Itinerary Management

- Create day-by-day itineraries.
- Add destinations, pickup points, activities, accommodation and notes.
- Edit itinerary before final confirmation.
- Send the approved itinerary to the customer.

Trip Preparation

- Check trip requirements.
- Assign an available vehicle.
- Assign driver and/or tour guide.
- Record pickup location and time.
- Record traveler requirements such as dietary, accessibility or language needs.

Customer Communication

- Send booking confirmations.
- Send payment reminders.
- Send itinerary updates.
- Send pre-trip and operational notifications.

Operations / Booking Staff - Cannot Do

- Create or promote users to Admin unless explicitly permitted.
- Change payment gateway credentials or security settings.
- Delete financial transaction history.
- Delete audit logs.
- Change company-wide permissions without authorization.
- Modify completed payment values manually.
- Access financial or management reports that are outside their assigned permission scope.

6. Role 3 - Driver / Tour Guide

The Driver / Tour Guide interface should be intentionally simple. The role should only access information required to deliver assigned trips safely and efficiently.

Driver / Tour Guide - Core Features

My Trips

- View today's assigned trip.
- View upcoming assigned trips.
- View completed assignments.

Assigned Trip Details

- Booking reference.
- Lead customer name and permitted contact information.
- Number of travelers.
- Pickup location and pickup time.
- Destination and day-by-day itinerary.
- Assigned vehicle.
- Emergency or operations contact.
- Relevant special requirements.

Trip Status Updates

- Assigned / Scheduled.
- Driving to pickup.
- Customer picked up.
- Trip or safari started.
- Destination reached or activity in progress.
- Return journey.
- Trip completed.

Operational Actions

- Report a vehicle issue.
- Report customer no-show or delay.
- Contact Operations.
- Add trip notes.
- Upload approved trip evidence or photos if enabled.

Driver / Tour Guide - Cannot Do

- View customers or trips not assigned to them.
- View company revenue or financial reports.
- Change safari package prices.
- Create or delete safari packages.
- Manage payments or refunds.
- Delete bookings.
- Manage other staff accounts.
- Change system settings or permissions.

Access Principle

A Driver or Tour Guide should normally see only the minimum customer and trip information required for assignments that are currently assigned to them.

7. Role 4 - Customer / Tourist

The Customer / Tourist is the main user of the website and mobile application. The customer experience should remain simple: Discover -> Plan -> Book -> Pay -> Travel.

Customer / Tourist - Core Features

Explore & Discover

- Browse destinations, safari packages and travel services.
- Search or filter by destination, duration, safari type, travel style or budget.
- View package photos, highlights, itinerary, inclusions, exclusions and pricing.

Booking

- Select travel dates.
- Select number of adults and children.
- Choose available package options.
- Add pickup information or optional services.
- Submit booking request or complete online booking depending on the booking model.

Traveler Management

- Add one or more travelers under a booking.
- Store traveler names and required travel information.
- Update allowed traveler details before the trip cutoff date.

Custom Safari Builder

- Select preferred destinations.
- Enter travel dates or expected travel period.
- Enter group size and budget range.
- Choose travel style such as budget, mid-range or luxury.
- Add special requests and submit a custom safari request.

Payments

- Pay deposit or full amount when supported.
- View paid amount and remaining balance.
- View payment status and transaction history.
- Download receipt or payment confirmation.

My Trips

- View upcoming, active and completed trips.
- View booking status.
- View itinerary, pickup details and accommodation information.
- View trip-related documents and updates where enabled.
- Contact M&A Safaris support or operations.

Profile & Communication

- Manage account profile.
- Manage preferred contact details.
- Receive booking, payment and trip notifications.
- Submit reviews or feedback after the trip.

Customer / Tourist - Cannot Do

- View another customer's bookings or personal data.
- Change confirmed package pricing.

- Assign vehicles, drivers or guides.
- Access internal staff notes.
- Change booking status directly outside the allowed customer actions.
- Mark their own payment as paid.
- Access Admin or Operations tools.

8. Main System Modules

The following modules form the recommended functional scope of the full web and mobile platform.

Module	What It Should Cover
Public Website / CMS	Home, about, services, destinations, packages, gallery, testimonials, contact, travel information, policies, SEO content.
Package Management	Package title, price, duration, itinerary, destinations, inclusions, exclusions, images, availability, published status.
Destination Management	Destination information, activities, images, packages connected to the destination, travel guidance.
Booking Engine	Travel date, group size, package options, booking request, confirmation, status, cancellation/reschedule rules.
Custom Safari Builder	Customer requirements, selected destinations, duration, budget, travel style, special requests, quotation and approval.
Customer CRM	Customer profiles, inquiries, notes, booking history, communication history and repeat-customer information.
Traveler Management	Multiple travelers under one booking, traveler details and special requirements.
Itinerary Management	Day-by-day trip plan, activities, destinations, accommodation, pickup details and customer-visible itinerary.
Trip Operations	Trip schedule, assignments, operational status, internal notes and trip completion.
Fleet Management	Vehicles, availability, maintenance status, schedules and assignments.
Driver / Guide Management	Staff profiles, availability, assigned trips and trip status updates.
Payments	Deposit/full payment, balances, payment status, receipts, refunds and financial history.
Notifications	Email, SMS, push or WhatsApp integration where approved for booking, payment and trip updates.
Reports	Bookings, revenue, payments, customers, packages, destinations, staff activity and vehicle utilization.
RBAC & Security	Roles, permissions, audit logs, secure authentication, protected financial actions and data access controls.

9. Recommended Web vs Mobile Feature Distribution

The website, customer app and staff tools do not need to duplicate every feature. Each interface should focus on the tasks that are most useful for that user.

Interface	Recommended Focus
Public Website	Discover M&A Safaris, destinations, services, packages, custom safari request, inquiries, booking, trust content and contact.

Interface	Recommended Focus
Customer App	My Trips, booking status, itinerary, payments, travelers, trip updates, support, documents and notifications.
Admin / Operations Web Dashboard	All management functions, booking desk, itinerary creation, trip planning, staff/vehicle assignments, reports and content management.
Driver / Guide Mobile App or Mobile Web	Assigned trips, pickup, itinerary, customer details required for the trip, operational updates and issue reporting.

10. Key End-to-End Workflows

A. Standard Safari Booking

1. Customer discovers package.
2. Customer selects dates and travelers.
3. Customer submits booking or pays required amount.
4. Booking is created.
5. Operations reviews and confirms the booking.
6. Itinerary is finalized.
7. Vehicle and Driver/Guide are assigned.
8. Customer receives final trip details.
9. Trip starts and operational status is updated.
10. Trip is completed and customer receives follow-up/review request.

B. Custom Safari Request

1. Customer selects destinations, dates, group size, budget and travel style.
2. Customer submits request.
3. Operations reviews the request.
4. Operations prepares itinerary and quotation.
5. Customer reviews the proposal and requests changes or accepts.
6. Final pricing and itinerary are confirmed.
7. Customer makes required payment.
8. Booking moves into normal trip preparation and operations flow.

C. Trip Operations

1. Confirmed booking enters the operations schedule.
2. Operations confirms accommodation, pickup and trip requirements.
3. Available vehicle is assigned.
4. Driver and/or guide is assigned.
5. Assigned staff sees the trip in My Trips.
6. Driver/Guide updates trip progress.
7. Operations monitors exceptions or issues.
8. Trip is marked completed and retained in customer and operational history.

11. High-Level Permission Matrix

Feature Area	Admin	Operations	Driver/Guide	Customer
View all bookings	Yes	Yes / permitted scope	No	No
Manage own booking	Yes	Yes	No	Yes

Feature Area	Admin	Operations	Driver/Guide	Customer
Create/edit packages	Yes	Optional permission	No	No
Manage destinations	Yes	Optional permission	No	No
Prepare itinerary	Yes	Yes	View assigned	View own
Assign vehicle / staff	Yes	Yes	No	No
Update trip progress	Yes	Yes	Yes - assigned only	View own
Manage payments	Yes	Limited	No	Own payments only
View financial reports	Yes	Limited permission	No	No
Manage staff / roles	Yes	No	No	No
Manage website content	Yes	Optional permission	No	No
System settings	Yes	No	No	No

12. Recommended First Version (MVP)

To keep the first release focused and practical, the first version can prioritize the features required to sell trips and operate confirmed bookings. More advanced automation can be added later.

- Public website with services, destinations and package pages.
- Customer registration/login and profile.
- Safari package management.
- Booking request / booking management.
- Custom safari request form and quotation workflow.
- Traveler management.
- Itinerary builder and customer itinerary view.
- Payment integration or payment-status management.
- Admin and Operations dashboards.
- Vehicle and Driver/Guide management.
- Trip assignment and status updates.
- Customer My Trips area.
- Basic notifications.
- Basic business reports.
- Role-based permissions and audit logs.

Possible Later Enhancements

- Live vehicle location / GPS tracking.
- Hotel and supplier partner portal.
- Advanced accounting integration.
- Automatic dynamic pricing.
- Multi-language content.
- Offline mode for drivers/guides in low-connectivity areas.
- Digital vouchers, travel documents and e-signatures.
- Advanced CRM automation and marketing campaigns.
- AI-assisted itinerary suggestions, subject to business approval.

13. Items to Confirm With the Client Before Development

The following decisions should be confirmed with M&A Safaris before final UI/UX design and backend development begin:

- Should customers book instantly, request a quotation first, or support both models?
- Which payment methods and currencies should be supported?
- Is a deposit required, full payment required, or both?
- What is the cancellation and rescheduling policy?
- Should car rental be booked independently from safari packages?
- Should Driver and Tour Guide be one combined role or two separate roles?
- Which staff members are allowed to confirm bookings and payments?
- Does M&A Safaris need hotel/accommodation management inside the system?
- Which customer documents are required before travel?
- Which notifications are required: email, SMS, push notification, WhatsApp, or a combination?
- Does the company need real-time vehicle tracking in the first version?
- Which reports are most important to management?
- Will the mobile application be customer-only, or should staff and drivers also use the same app with role-based screens?

Recommended Next Discussion

Confirm the booking model, payment flow, staff workflow, Driver/Guide workflow, and the exact features required in the first release. After those decisions, the project can move into UI/UX screens, database design, APIs, and implementation planning.

END OF DISCUSSION DOCUMENT